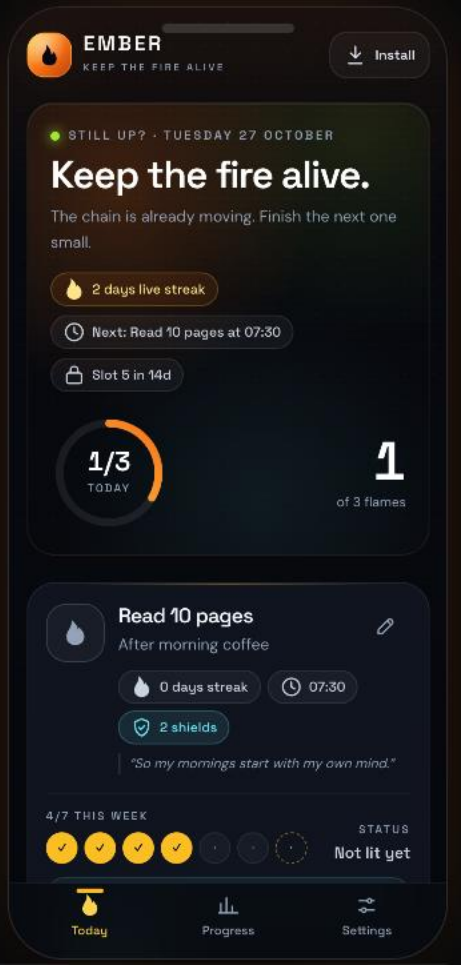
A LOCAL-FIRST HABIT TRACKER

Keep the fire alive.

A streak you want to protect. A small number of promises. A repair for the day life happens.

No server · Installable · Offline · Dark by design



THE HARD PART IS THE DAY AFTER THE MISS

Most trackers optimise for logging, not returning.

∞

An unlimited list

More habits means more ways to fail on any given day.

0

The reset

A single miss erases the only number that was motivating.

18–254

Days to automaticity

The habit is slow. The app has to make returning feel survivable.

> “Missing one opportunity did not materially affect the habit formation process.” — Lally et al., 2010



One gap is not a verdict.

A shield covers yesterday. The chain survives, and the habit gets another day.

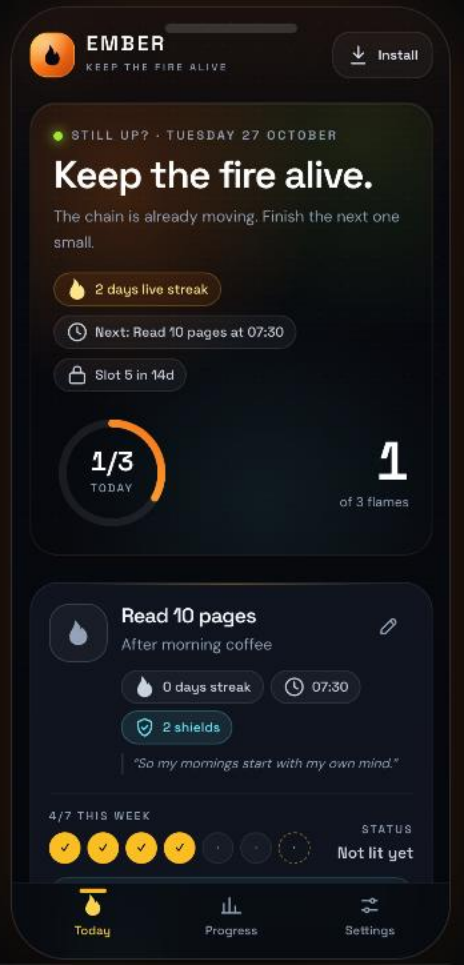
ONE LOOP. ONE FLAME.

Small enough to survive a bad day.

01 **The cue**
"After morning coffee." A named moment, not a vague intention.

02 **The tap**
One native button. It lights, it persists, it can be undone.

03 **The next link**
The live streak, the week, and the next slot stay visible.



SCARCITY THAT TEACHES

Start with one. Earn the right to carry more.

1 **Start** — Day one

2 **3-day best** — Return proven

3 **7-day best** — A week

4 **14-day best** — Two weeks

5 **30-day best** — A month

Never bought

No store, no currency, no loot box. Only evidence.

Never farmed

Shields repair the visible streak, but never unlock a slot.

Never lost

Archive keeps history and capacity. Deleting the evidence is the only exit.

> The limit is the product: few promises, kept.

EVIDENCE-INFORMED, NOT EVIDENCE-WASHED

Four mechanisms. One honest loop.

IMPLEMENTATION INTENTIONS

Name the moment

A cue and a time turn "I should" into "when X, I will Y".

94 tests, medium-to-large effect, d = 0.65. Gollwitzer & Sheeran, 2006.

RECOVERY

One miss is not the habit

Seven completions earn a shield. It repairs yesterday, not the record.

Repair attenuates the engagement drop after a broken streak. Silverman & Barasch, 2023.

GOAL GRADIENT

Show the real distance

The next slot is a real threshold with a real bar. No fake stamps.

Effort rises near a goal. Kivetz, Urminsky & Zheng, 2006.

LOSS AVERSION

Pressure with a curfew

At-risk copy appears only after 20:00, only for a ritual that is actually dark.

Losses loom larger than gains. Kahneman & Tversky, 1979.

The 18–254 day range is from Lally et al., 2010. "66 days" is a median, not a rule. The app designs for the range, not the meme.

"DARK PATTERNS FOR YOUR BENEFIT" IS A DANGEROUS BRIEF

Pressure, not deception.

USED, TRANSPARENTLY

- Earned scarcity — one slot, then 3 / 7 / 14 / 30 days
- Real loss aversion — a real flame, after 20:00
- Goal gradient — the actual distance to the next slot
- Commitment — a cue, a time, a one-line reason
- Recovery — a shield that can only cover yesterday

REFUSED

- Confirm-shaming and guilt copy
- Fake urgency and manufactured countdowns
- Invented social proof
- Pre-ticked consent and hidden costs
- A roach motel for your own data

> If the user could read the mechanic and still choose it, it stays. Settings → "How Ember persuades" prints the whole list.

Dark-pattern taxonomy: Gray et al., CHI 2018 · Mathur et al., CSCW 2019.

HONEST ABOUT THE PLATFORM

A reminder that knows what it cannot do.

App open: a real notification

A minute tick checks timed, unlit rituals. Permission is requested from a user gesture, never on load. If it is denied, the same message becomes an in-app alert.

SERVICE WORKER · ONCE PER DAY

App closed: the calendar

A closed serverless PWA cannot schedule a local notification. One tap exports a daily .ics event with an alarm for every timed ritual.

OS-LEVEL ALARM · NO SERVER

iOS 16.4+ web push requires a Home Screen app and a push server. Ember has no server, so it does not promise push. That is why the calendar export exists.

- **Granted** system notification
- **Denied** in-app alert
- **Closed** calendar alarm

A TAB IS A WEBSITE. THE ICON IS AN APP.

Install it. Then forget the browser.

iPhone

Safari → Share → Add to Home Screen.

STANDALONE

Android

Chrome menu → Install app, or the in-app prompt.

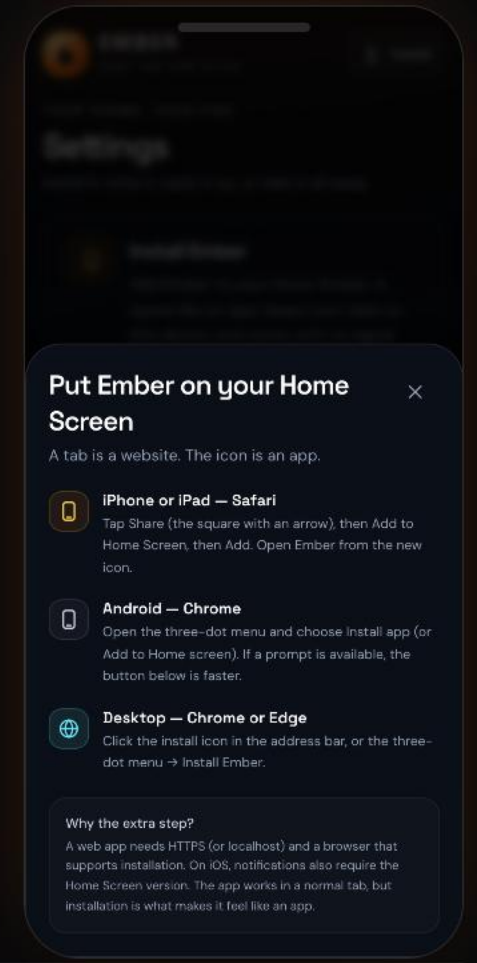
HOME SCREEN

Desktop

Install icon in the address bar, or the browser menu.

OFFLINE

Service worker caches the shell, fonts and icons. No API calls. Data stays in this browser; export is the backup because iOS can evict site data.



SMALL SURFACE, TESTED CORE

The evidence is in the build.

28 tests in the pure domain	**102** assertions, 0 failures	**320** px minimum width exercised
0 backend or third-party calls	**1** tap to light a ritual	**5** slots, never purchasable

ClojureScript · Reagent · Tailwind dark · PWA · localStorage · cljs.test · No backend

Browser exercise: onboarding · persistence across reload · shield repair · archive · slot limit · JSON export/import · .ics download · keyboard focus + Escape · 320/390/768 px · offline reload.

01 **Pure domain**
model.cljs: dates, streaks, slots, shields, reminders, ICalendar.

→

02 **One atom**
main.cljs owns the clock, ids and the persistence watch.

→

03 **Effects at the edge**
storage and platform, both isolated, both named with intent.

START WITH ONE. KEEP IT LIT.

One small flame.

A habit tracker that treats a missed day as data, not a verdict. The limit is the point. The repair is earned. The data stays yours.

```
npm run dev
```

README.md · RESEARCH.md · BUILD-PLAN.md · REQUIREMENTS.md

